MUSIC

SINGIN' IN THE RAIN

It's raining **new releases** as the monsoon makes concerts a no-go and Indian musicians hit the studio instead

Bhanuj Kappal

The monsoon is now in full swing, which means—for most Indian musicians at least—that it's time to take a break from the road and hit the studio. The rains make large, open-air concerts practically impossible, while even smaller club gigs run the risk of low attendance due to unpredictable weather that keeps many fans indoors. It's a reality that leaves fans of live music jonesing for their fix, but on the bright side, this is also the season for new music. Every monsoon, we see a glut of new releases from artists both established and new. It's a key time for musicians and music fans—new stars are born, new classics added to the pantheon of great music, new sounds come to define the year ahead. To help you navigate this flood of new music, we've put together a sampling of some of the most interesting releases by Indian artists in July, from all over the country (and abroad).



MATHANGI JAGDISH

Major Troubles in Minor Blues

After 20 years of singing other people's songs as a playback singer, Bengaluru-based Coke Studio star Mathangi Jagdish wants to reinvent herself, this time as a jazz musician. On her debut three-track EP, the veteran singer-songwriter explores swing, R&B and big band sounds while touching on topics like procrastination and the capriciousness of our moods and mental health. Jagdish's biggest asset is her bold, versatile voice, and she deploys it to great effect here.



TABA CHAKE, *Halfway*

Arunachal Pradesh native Taba Chake's music has some of the quiet, pastoral quality of the hill state's countryside, which he blends masterfully with twee acoustic guitar lines and the subtle, understated melodies of classic early 2000s indie-pop. His upcoming single 'Halfway' picks up from where his last release—the Sufjan Stevens-indebted Assamese tear-jerker 'Monot Pore'—left off, with sun-dappled synths and finger-plucked guitar providing the musical backdrop to soaring, celestial vocals about being stuck "halfway" through life.





HARRDY SANDHU

Pleasures

Ever since breaking out in 2012 with his debut single 'Tequila Shot', Harrdy Sandhu has focused on refining his folksy Punjabi pop sound. On his new EP *Pleasures*, he takes a left-field turn, bringing in elements of western pop, dance music and synth-pop to craft a contemporary global sound. Highlights include the Karan Kanchan-produced 'Psycho' with its minimal synths and smooth R&B vocals, and the club-ready 'Love Hate'.

